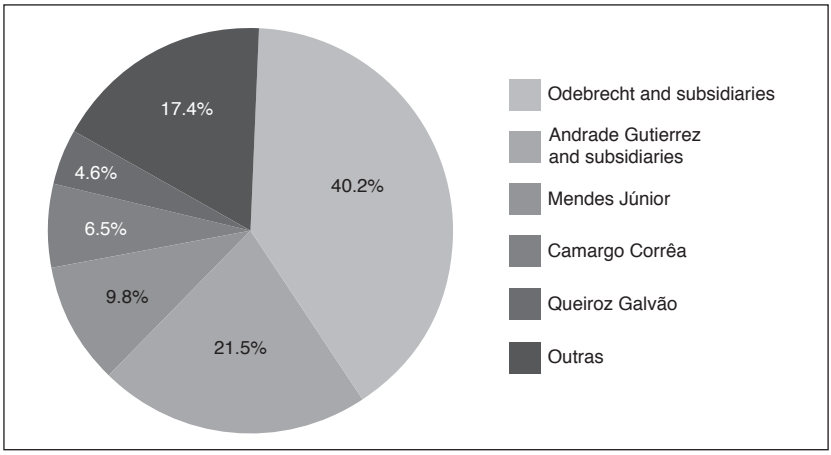
Figure 5. Brazilian contractor overseas constructions, by firm



Source: prepared by the author.

precisely in those areas where historically they had greatest domestic experience. Thus they built roads, dams and hydroelectric plants above all; that is, precisely the type of construction they had built domestically and which also corresponded to the type of road transport and energy generation characteristic of the Brazilian economy. In this way, the contractors seemed to export the Brazilian development model effective from the mid-1950s, characterised by the pattern of road transport and the model of electricity generation on the basis of hydroelectric plants. Brazilian contractors did not have the same drive to construct railways, ports or thermoelectric facilities abroad; they did not have the same experience in these niches. Among the works listed in Figure 4 as 'other works', we find diverse types of construction such as urbanisation projects, pipelines, specialised engineering structures (bridges, viaducts and tunnels), stadiums, industrial works, electrical installations, etc.

Finally, to complete this picture of the trends and characteristics of the internationalisation process of Brazilian firms, it is interesting to examine Figure 5 in which the concentration of construction abroad by firm is shown. What one perceives in the process of Brazilian contractor internationalisation is an elevated degree of concentration. Thus, if at least 37 Brazilian heavy construction firms had overseas contracts, only five held 82.6% of the total between 1969 and 2010. One group, Odebrecht and its subsidiaries, held more than 40% of all the contracts that heavy construction companies established overseas. However, at the beginning of the process in the 1970s, various firms were constructing